Laboratory Exercise 0
Introduction to the Digital Laboratory (Pre-session Lab)

Introduction

This first laboratory session requires no knowledge of logic design. Its purpose is to make you comfortable with the equipment and the design flow that you will use for the rest of the course: the breadboard, the power supply, the digital multimeter, the oscilloscope, standard TTL (Transistor-Transistor Logic) ICs, and the Intel Quartus Prime software together with the DE0-CV FPGA board. Along the way you will see, with your own measurements, that a digital signal is just an analog voltage interpreted as '0' or '1', and that a TTL input draws current. The lab is planned for two hours (see the time given in each part). Logisim, a light-weight tool for drawing and simulating small circuits, is introduced in Lab 1; from then on you can use it, in addition to Quartus Prime, for schematic design and simulation.

Objectives

1. To build a circuit on a breadboard safely and to power it correctly.
2. To use a digital multimeter and an oscilloscope to measure DC voltages and time-varying signals.
3. To calculate and verify the current in an LED circuit using Ohm's law.
4. To represent a binary number with switches and LEDs.
5. To understand the input voltage levels and the input current of a TTL gate, and why the pull-down resistor of an input must be small.
6. To create, compile and download a simple Quartus Prime schematic project to the DE0-CV board.

Equipment Required

- DC Power Supply (+5V)
- Digital Multimeter
- Digital Oscilloscope and probes
- Function Generator
- Breadboard and Jumper Wires
- TTL IC: 74LS04 (Hex Inverter / NOT Gate)
- Resistors: 330Ω (LEDs and pull-down), 1 $k\Omega$
- 10 $k\Omega$ resistor
- 4-position DIP switch
- LEDs (Red/Green)
- Intel DE0-CV board with USB cable, and a PC with Quartus Prime installed
- (Optional) Logisim or Logisim-evolution: a light-weight tool for drawing and simulating small circuits at home or in the laboratory. It cannot program the DE0-CV board, so Quartus Prime is still needed for the board.

Safety Notes

- **Always switch the power supply OFF** before changing any wiring on the breadboard.
- Set the supply to +5 V and confirm it with the multimeter *before* connecting it to the breadboard. TTL ICs can be damaged by more than 7 V.
- Never connect a power rail directly to ground. Never connect an LED to +5 V without a series resistor.
- Connect Pin 14 (V_{CC}) and Pin 7 (GND) of every IC *first*, and double-check them before switching on.
- The input/output pins of the FPGA on the DE0-CV board work at 3.3 V. **Never connect the 5 V TTL circuits on your breadboard to the FPGA pins of the board.**

Part I: Breadboard, Power and Ohm's Law (about 20 min)

Breadboard Basics

A breadboard connects holes in a pattern: the holes in each short vertical column (5 holes) are connected together, while the long rows along the edge (power rails) are connected along their whole length. Use the red rail for +5 V and the blue rail for ground.

1. Turn on the power supply, set it to +5 V and measure it with the multimeter. Record the value: _____ V.
2. Turn the supply off. Connect the supply to the power rails of the breadboard (red for +5 V, blue for GND).

LED and Series Resistor

An LED conducts current only in one direction (from the anode, the longer leg, to the cathode). Its brightness depends on the current, which is limited by a series resistor.

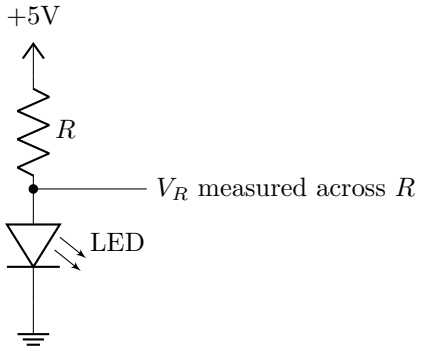


Figure 1: LED with a series resistor.

Build the circuit of Figure 1 with $R = 330\,\Omega$ and then with $R = 1\,k\Omega$. For each resistor, measure the voltage across the resistor (V_R) and across the LED (V_{LED}). Calculate the LED current from Ohm's law, $I = V_R/R$.

R	V_R **(V)**	V_{LED} **(V)**	$I = V_R/R$ **(mA)**	**Brightness**
$330\,\Omega$				
$1\,k\Omega$				

Table 1: LED current measurement.

1. Check your result: does $5\,\text{V} = V_R + V_{LED}$ (approximately)?

2. A typical red LED needs about 10 mA for good brightness. What is the smallest standard resistor that keeps the current below 20 mA? Show your calculation.

Part II: Switches, LEDs and Binary Numbers (about 25 min)

Switch Input Circuit

A mechanical switch alone does not produce a clean logic level: when it is open, the input is left "floating". A resistor connects the input to ground so that an open switch gives a well-defined logic 0. Build the switch circuit of Figure 2 for each of the four DIP switches.

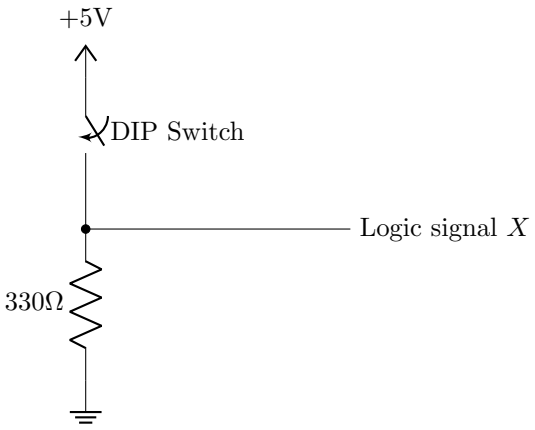


Figure 2: Input switch circuit (active high): $X = 1$ when the switch is ON, $X = 0$ when OFF.

LED Indicator Stage

A 74LS-series gate output can *sink* (absorb) much more current than it can *source* (supply): about 8 mA versus only 0.4 mA. For this reason, throughout this course, LEDs on the breadboard are connected between +5 V and the output of an inverter, as in Figure 3. The LED is lit when the inverter output is low, that is, when its input X is high. We will call this circuit the **LED indicator stage**.

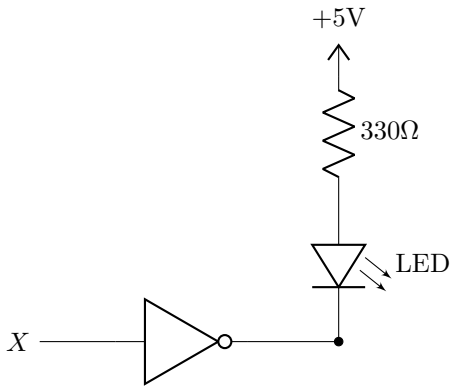


Figure 3: LED indicator stage (one inverter of the 74LS04): the LED is ON when $X = 1$.

Note: the LED symbol is drawn so that its cathode is connected to the inverter output and its anode to the resistor.

Binary Display

1. Place the 74LS04 on the breadboard and connect Pin 14 to +5 V and Pin 7 to GND.
2. Connect the four switch signals X_3, X_2, X_1, X_0 (Figure 2) to four inverter inputs, and an LED indicator stage to each inverter output. LED_i should be ON when switch X_i is ON.

3. Set the switches to the patterns of Table 2. Write the decimal value represented by the pattern, and complete the empty rows with patterns of your choice.

X_3	X_2	X_1	X_0	**Hex**	**Decimal**
0	0	0	0		
0	1	0	1		
1	0	1	0		
1	1	1	1		
				7	
					12

Table 2: Switch patterns and the numbers they represent.

4. How many different patterns can 4 switches represent? How many for 8 switches? _____

Part III: TTL Inputs and Logic Levels (about 25 min)

Digital circuits still work with voltages: a gate input decides whether the voltage it sees is a '0' or a '1' by comparing it with threshold levels. For the 74LS04 the data sheet guarantees:

- Input is read as logic 0 if $V_{in} \leq V_{IL(max)} = 0.8\,\text{V}$, and as logic 1 if $V_{in} \geq V_{IH(min)} = 2.0\,\text{V}$. Between these values the result is not guaranteed.
- The output is $V_{OL} \leq 0.5\,\text{V}$ for logic 0 and $V_{OH} \geq 2.7\,\text{V}$ for logic 1.
- **Input currents:** when the input is low, the gate *sources* up to $I_{IL} = 0.4\,\text{mA}$ out of the input pin; when the input is high, it *absorbs* only $I_{IH} = 20\,\mu\text{A}$.

Input Current and the Pull-down Resistor

A TTL input is not a high-impedance input like an input of a CMOS gate. The current I_{IL} flows out of the pin and through the pull-down resistor R of the switch circuit (Figure 2), so the voltage at the input of the gate is approximately $V_{in} \approx I_{IL} \cdot R$ when the switch is OFF. This voltage must stay below $V_{IL(max)}$.

1. Calculate the largest pull-down resistor that guarantees a valid logic 0: $R_{max} = V_{IL(max)}/I_{IL(max)} =$ _____ Ω. For $R = 330\,\Omega$, $V_{in} \approx$ _____ V.
2. Build one switch circuit with $R = 330\,\Omega$ and connect it to an inverter of the 74LS04 with an LED indicator stage on the output. With the switch OFF, measure V_{in} at the gate input with the multimeter, and note the LED state.
3. Replace R by $1\,k\Omega$ and then by $10\,k\Omega$ and repeat. Complete Table 3.

R	V_{in} measured (switch OFF)	LED state	Logic level read by the gate	V_{in} valid 0?
$330\,\Omega$				
$1\,k\Omega$				
$10\,k\Omega$				

Table 3: Effect of the pull-down resistor on a 74LS input.

4. Explain the results. Why is a large pull-down resistor (for example $10\,k\Omega$), which is common in CMOS circuits, not suitable for TTL inputs?
5. A *pull-up* resistor to $+5\,\text{V}$ that holds an input high only has to supply $I_{IH} = 20\,\mu\text{A}$. Why is a pull-up much less critical than a pull-down for TTL? What is the price of a small resistor, in terms of current, when the switch connects it to the opposite level?

Oscilloscope Observation (about 10 min)

1. Set the function generator to a 1 kHz **sine wave**, 0–5 V (use the DC-offset control). Connect it to the input of an inverter and to Channel 1 of the oscilloscope. Connect Channel 2 to the inverter output. The oscilloscope ground clips must be connected to the circuit ground.

2. Observe both channels. What is the shape of V_{out}? _____ Sketch the capture and explain how an analog waveform becomes a digital signal.

3. (*If time permits*) Change the generator to a **square wave** of about 1 MHz and measure the propagation delay between the 50% points of the input and output edges: $t_{pd} \approx$ _____ ns.

Part IV: Introduction to Quartus Prime and the DE0-CV Board (about 40 min)

In this part you will go through the complete FPGA design flow once, using a trivially simple circuit. No VHDL is needed: you will draw the circuit as a schematic. The DE0-CV board has 10 slide switches (SW9–SW0), 4 push buttons (KEY3–KEY0), and 10 red LEDs (LEDR9–LEDR0). **The push buttons produce logic 0 while pressed.**

1. Start Quartus Prime and create a new project with **File → New Project Wizard**. Name the project and the top-level entity `lab0`. Select the device used on the DE0-CV board (Cyclone V 5CEBA4F23C7).

2. Create a new Block Diagram/Schematic File (**File → New → Block Diagram/Schematic File**) and save it as `lab0.bdf`.

3. Place four input pins named `SW[3..0]`, and four output pins named `LEDR[3..0]`. Connect each switch directly to the LED with the same number by wires. Use the same bus names that appear in the DE0-CV pin-assignment file or User Manual.

4. Add one more input pin `KEY0`, one **NOT** gate and one output pin `LEDR9`. Connect `KEY0` → `NOT` → `LEDR9`.

5. Make the pin assignments with the **Pin Planner**, using the DE0-CV User Manual (or the pin-assignment file supplied by your instructor).

6. Compile the project (**Processing → Start Compilation**). Note the number of logic elements (or ALMs) used: _____.

7. Connect the board using the USB cable, open the **Programmer**, select the USB-Blaster, and download the `lab0.sof` file.

8. Operate the switches and the push button and complete Table 4.

Action	LEDs lit
All switches OFF; KEY0 not pressed	
SW3 ON	
SW0, SW2 ON	
KEY0 pressed	

Table 4: Observed behavior of the DE0-CV circuit.

9. Why is a NOT gate necessary for `KEY0` if we want the LED to light *while* the button is pressed?

10. Name the four main steps (compiler stages) that Quartus runs during compilation and describe in one sentence what each does.

Check-off

Before leaving the laboratory, show your instructor or teaching assistant:

1. Table 1 and the LED current calculation.
2. The binary display of Part II working for all switches.
3. Table 3 and the oscilloscope capture of Part III.
4. The circuit running on the DE0-CV board (Part IV).

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